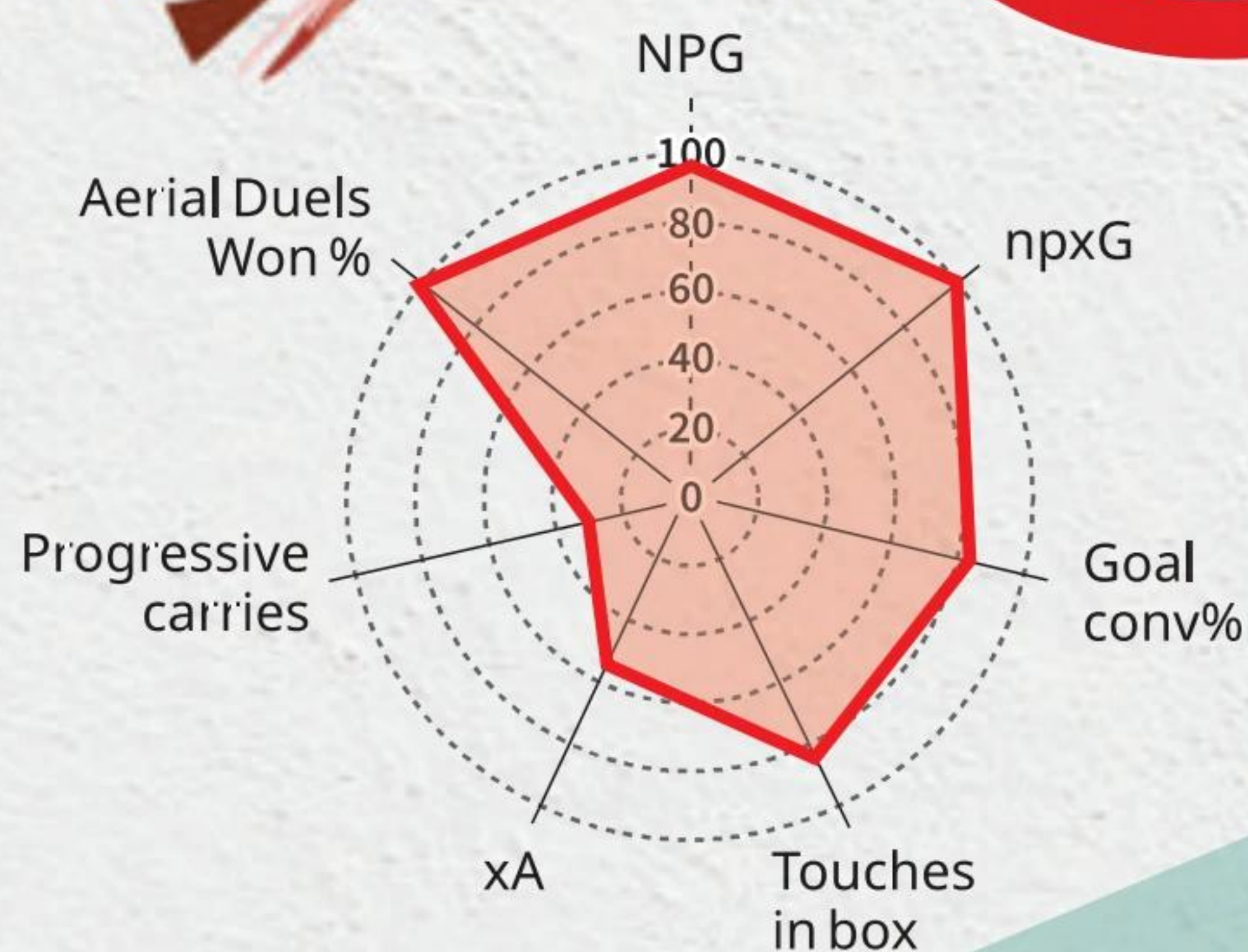




Haaland
2025/26
season stats
(for club):

Appearances
52

Goals **38** | Assists **9**



NORWEGIAN GOAL MACHINE

1

Erling Haaland helped Norway qualify for the World Cup after 28 years. The last time his country played in the tournament, the striker wasn't even born! Making his senior international debut in 2019, he took just five years to become Norway's highest goalscorer. Since then, he has become an absolute goal machine, reaching 50 international goals in 46 matches, 61 quicker than Lionel Messi and 68 faster than Cristiano Ronaldo.

2
But there is another side to Haaland. Along with Norway's then under-17 players Erik Botheim and Erik Tobias Sandberg, Haaland released a single called 'Kygo jo' as part of a boyband named Flow Kingz, which has over 15 million views on YouTube.

LIONEL MESSI

The talismanic Argentine has been in both spectrums of the World Cup — an agonising defeat in the final (2014) and a dramatic win in Qatar (2022). Having won the Major League Soccer title with Inter Miami in the USA — guiding the club to its maiden triumph — the 38-year-old has little left to win.

Messi, for long, has lived as the successor to Diego Maradona, another World Cup-winning captain. For Maradona, the World Cup after the victorious edition ended in tears. The wizard from Rosario will look to avoid that and hope to realise the American dream in his final flourish.

